

CDN Incident Alert: 0076. TLP: CLEAR		Date
Title	EU Meta May Have Channelled Money to EU-sanctioned Entities via Facebook's Revenue Redistribution Programs	23/06/2025

Summary

- Meta Platforms Ireland Ltd. maintained – and initiated – Facebook revenue redistribution partnerships with RT, Sputnik and other EU-sanctioned entities for months after EU sanctions were introduced.
- Impacted pages: Sputnik (1.4m), Sputnik France (774k), Sputnik Italia (405k), SNA (210k), RT Arabic* (1.1m), Polina Gagarina (610k), Egountchi Behanzin* (366k). *still monetized as of June 2025
- EU, European Governments, Meta, and media were notified. Meta Platforms Ireland Ltd. and other social media companies should be investigated for potential sanction violations through monetization services. EU should leverage DSA and Democracy Shield to strengthen its regulatory oversight.

Incident

Russia Today (RT) and Sputnik have monetized from Facebook since 2020.

In February 2022, Meta [demonetized](#) all RT and Sputnik-affiliated Facebook pages. The EU introduced broadcasting sanctions against RT and Sputnik on [1 March 2022](#) and financial sanctions against their parent entities on [16 December 2022](#) and [25 February 2023](#).

In October 2022, Meta re-monetized the [Sputnik](#), [Sputnik France](#), [Sputnik Italia](#) and [SNA](#) (Sputnik Deutschland) pages (listed up to October 2023). [Sputnik France](#), [Sputnik Italia](#) and [SNA](#) were not only restored to their original program, but also added onto a new one, a process requiring formal onboarding review and contracting. In July 2023, Meta onboarded a new page for [RT Arabic](#) (still listed as of June 2025). Meta received payment from ads from the page through to at least [March 2024](#).

[Polina Gagarina](#) (sanctioned [June 2024](#)) and Sylvain Afoua, aka [Egountchi Behanzin](#) (sanctioned [May 2025](#)) also listed as monetized post sanctions. As of June 2025, Afoua's page is still monetized, accessible within the EU, and using Facebook's audience subscription feature.

Various unverified pages broadcasting content from sanctioned Russian media outlets are also monetizing.

Narrative

N/A

Impact

Funds: Meta may be bankrolling Russian propagandists. € amount TBC by Meta.

Sanctions: Meta's sanction controls are inadequate (failure of both business partner qualification review process + ongoing tracking and application of sanctions to existing partners).

Monetization Systems: Meta's monetization systems (enforcement/public disclosures) are also inadequate. More transparency and regulatory oversight are urgently needed.

Key Objectives and Behaviours ([DISARM Red Framework](#))

N/A.

Recommendations and Actions Taken (end each recommendation with a ;)

Action taken: Reported possible sanction violations to EU, Irish, French and Italian sanction authorities.

Communicated findings to European Commission, European Parliament and European Council. Communicated findings to Meta's leadership. In the process of communicating findings to advertisers and tech investors. Press coverage: Politico, Le Monde, Sueddeutsche Zeitung, Radio Liberty.

Recommendations: EU should leverage DSA to request information from Meta and other platforms on revenue redistribution to sanctioned entities and actors broadcasting content from sanctioned media outlets. Member States should initiate infringement proceedings if sanction violations are identified (see [EC's Consolidated FAQs](#)). EU should leverage the DSA and Democracy Shield to strengthen its regulatory oversight of social media platforms' monetization services.

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